

THE GIRL WHO CRIED GHOUL

Paranormal Nobodies – Episode 105

Written by

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EXT. BLACK WILLOW WOODS - NIGHT

The far off laughter of children loses itself in the dark. Two pre-teen girls, RUBY and JANE, navigate the eerie forest. Both are dressed as witches.

JANE
Ruby, keep up!

Ruby lags behind, clutching a flashlight.

RUBY
I'm trying not to trip and die,
thank you. Why did I even let you
talk me into this?

JANE
It's the best spot for a Halloween
seance. Just trust me.

Ruby groans. Jane smirks and stops, shining her flashlight ahead.

JANE
Look.

Ruby catches up, her beam joining Jane's to illuminate a stone slab, half-buried beneath ivy.

RUBY
That's the crest thing?

JANE
No. That's the grave of a 1980s
heiress who was never found.

Jane gives Ruby the spooky eyes, then shines her light on a piece of metal placed at its foot: THE GOOD CREST.

JANE (cont'D)
That is the crest.

A faint whisper weaves through the trees. Ruby stiffens.

RUBY
Did you hear that?

JANE
Stop trying to freak me out.

Behind them, glowing in the dark, ruby EYES watch.

Jane
I'm sure it's just an animal...

Her focus shifts to THE CREST.

FADE TO:

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, SILO FIRST FLOOR - NIGHT

Another GOOD CREST. On a TRUNK in the dusty silo.

JILL
My goodness, Dylan. I'm not the
devil... you can go in this. Your
grandmother's cotillion dress.

JILL RAMIREZ unlocks the wardrobe, revealing an ethereal,
black BALL GOWN. She turns to DYLAN KLAYPOOL (now 17).

DYLAN
Black?

JILL
Well, she was awfully strange. Is.

They exchange a look. Is. Dylan circles the dress, cautious.

JILL
(CONT'D)
I believe there's a hat that'll
match. Somewhere around here.

Dylan shoots back a look.

JILL
(CONT'D)
...If you want to be a witch.

EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

The floor is fog. Dylan swims into the front yard,
attempting to sway. The lace trim, intertwined ribbon, the
tulle to hold her satin: it's otherworldly. Like the dress is
made of Dylan's same stuff.

JILL (O.S.)
I found it.

Jill, teary eyed, holds an ever-classic WITCH'S HAT.

TITLE CARD: EPISODE 5, THE GIRL WHO CRIED GHOUL.

MITCH (V.O.)
You remind me of the snow.

INT. HALLOWEEN DANCE - NIGHT

Dylan's stimulation holds sway. He's looking at her, MITCH VERLICE, as if it were his last chance.

MITCH (V.O.)
You're cold, but it makes you
lighter.

A SOBBING SOUND. Black hearts fall from the sky.

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, HALLWAY - NIGHT

Dylan forces herself to breathe.

MITCH (V.O.)
Everything about you lands lighter.

INT. HALLOWEEN DANCE - NIGHT

Mitch breaks away, turning to Carrie. Moth to flame.

MITCH (V.O.)
And somehow, after a while...

A rampage of peers. Dylan is bumped and bruised by boys.

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, MS. MARRERO'S CLASSROOM - NIGHT

Dylan forces herself to breathe.

MITCH (V.O.)
When it happens no one knows...

INT. HALLOWEEN DANCE - NIGHT

Mitch puts his arm around CARRIE LANDRY.

MITCH (V.O.)
(MORE)

MITCH (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Everything's covered in you.

Black hearts cover the floor.

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, MS. MARRERO'S CLASSROOM - NIGHT

Dylan catches her reflection in the window. Trottled on.

DYLAN (V.O.)
It sounds dangerous.

With THREE SOFT KNOCKS, reality returns.

DYLAN
Just a second!

SAWYER HALL opens the door, peaks his head in.

SAWYER
Dylan?

DYLAN
Hey!..I think I'm gonna go.

SAWYER
Wait. I'll walk you home.

When she stands, his hand softens into hers. Unheard of.

SAWYER
(feeling silly)
Uh... after at least one dance.

Oh, she's not so sure. Give it a chance, give it a chance.

He gets wired HEADPHONES, handing her one: "SHINE ON, HARVEST MOON" by Ruth Etting. Between press and play, Sawyer pays close attention to her reaction: she loves this song!

My goodness, he even does a fancy bow. She laughs. They dance, comfort growing. Dylan rests her head on his shoulder.

DYLAN
Thank you.

EXT. BLACK WILLOW WOODS - NIGHT

The forest BREATHES. Dylan and Sawyer WALK wordlessly through the woods. She's wearing his jacket, and he helps her over the logs. They come upon a thick wall of fog. Dylan grabs her necklace.

SAWYER
Woah... be careful.

He guides her into the unknown, gentle.

A SNAKE!

SAWYER
(CONT'D)
Dylan! Watch out!

Sawyer PICKS her up. Salem 1692 FLASHES into Dylan's mind:

FLASH: An orange snake. It's gentle.

DOROTHY (V.O.)
He is a friend.

MAN (O.S.)
He's her familiar!

FLASH: Dorothy looks up, turning her head slowly, as if someone saw her. It's uncanny.

SALEM GIRLS
(echoed as though to
come)
Witch, witch, witch, witch!

FLASH: The clang of jail doors slamming shut echos...

...Bringing Dylan back to reality.

DYLAN
Awfully strange.

SAWYER
Dylan...

Dylan follows the warning sound of Sawyer's voice. He points down to a BEAR TRAP.

SAWYER
(CONT'D)
That snake just saved your life.

DYLAN
(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)
...Your's too.

They look out, frazzled and grateful to be alive.

EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, FRONT DOOR - NIGHT

The lights are on in Dylan's house, the fog thick before it. Dylan and Sawyer approach the door. She takes off his jacket.

SAWYER
Keep it.

DYLAN
It looks better on you.

Sawyer smiles.

SAWYER
That was crazy.

DYLAN
I know.

They're talking about the snake. They exchange a meaningful stare and hug tightly. Let go.

SAWYER
Dylan, um, uh...

He laughs at himself a little.

DYLAN
What? What is it?

SAWYER
Would you like to go on a date with me?

DYLAN
...sure. I'd love to go on a date with you, Sawyer.

SAWYER
You, you wanna go apple picking?

DYLAN
I'd love to go apple picking.

SAWYER
(MORE)

SAWYER (CONT'D)
OK. Tomorrow? I can pick you up
early. That's when they're best.

DYLAN
Early? That's when the, the
orchards are best?

Sawyer nods, all blush.

DYLAN
(CONT'D)

SAWYER
It's a date.

DYLAN
OK. Good night, Sawyer.

SAWYER
Good night, Dylan.

Dylan goes inside. Sawyer stands on the doorstep, apple red.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Jill's shoes dangle on crossed legs, tapping to the clock.
The front door opens, closes. Dylan rests on it: Much to
think about. She turns, startles! Jill does not laugh.

DYLAN
What?

JILL
555-0854.

Dylan's brows furrow in confusion.

JILL DYLAN
555-0854. 555-0854. 555-0854!

Yelled simultaneously with:

DYLAN
WHAT ARE YOU DOING?

JILL
That's the number to Nathan's psych
ward. But you already have it.
(MORE)

JILL (CONT'D)

Don't you?

She holds up Dylan's phone, showing it's call history.

DYLAN

...You had no right to go through
my phone.

JILL

Do not, Dylan.

DYLAN

Why would you do that? Why would
you go through my phone when we
were doing so well?

Spoken simultaneously with:

JILL

Dylan Kassandra Klaypool, do not
turn this on me. I needed to
contact your friends and get the
phone back to you before the dance
was up so you wouldn't have to walk
home alone.

DYLAN

I didn't walk home alone.

JILL

Right and with this string of
behavior, I assume you were
escorted by Mitch.

She holds up Dylan's pink birthday letter from Mitch.

JILL

Very clever of him to pass this off
as a gift from Carrie.

DYLAN

I was not escorted back by Mitch,
OK? Can you just leave me alone.

JILL

No.

DYLAN

I'm allowed to talk to my dad!

JILL

NO YOU ARE NOT. Not when he's a
(MORE)

JILL (CONT'D)
criminally insane abuser who-

Jill stops herself. Tries to breathe.

Jill
Took advantage of you in your
innocence.

DYLAN
He never. Did that.

JILL
Dylan. This is the first step to
recovery, Dylan. I know it is
difficult to believe, but he did.

DYLAN
No, he DIDN'T!!!

Just then, a window BURSTS open and a GALE of cold wind
howls through the house. Jill blinks, looks borderline
panicked.

JILL
Honey...you've been manipulated-

DYLAN
The only one manipulating me is
you! With your statistics and your
makeovers and that condescending
voice. I'm not crazy. I know what I
saw and I know it was real.

JILL
I'm not saying you're crazy. I'm
saying you were six-years-old.

DYLAN
It doesn't make a difference.

The wind grows stronger, knocking things over and sending
Dylan's hair all arise.

JILL
Really? Really? You believe that
there was truly some faceless,
black spirit coming into our house
at night to drag you with it? Does
it have a name? Maybe it's parents
and I can sit down and have a talk.
Oh, ghost! Dylan wonders where
you've been since her father was
(MORE)

JILL (CONT'D)
locked away!

Argued simultaneously with:

DYLAN
Shut up. Shut up, shut up! SHUT UP!
Stop it! STOP!

LAMPS flicker. Dylan pulls her NECKLACE out and clutches onto it like a life raft, KISSING it.

JILL
Dylan, give that to me right now.
Dylan, I know he gave it to you.
Dylan. GIVE IT TO ME NOW.

DYLAN
No!

JILL
Dylan, I'm asking this one time and then I will have no choice but to take it from you.

DYLAN
It protects me.

Jill yanks the necklace off and smashes it to pieces.

JILL
I PROTECT YOU. That was symbol of the power an abuser still holds over you. Do you understand?

DYLAN
Yes.

JILL
What?

DYLAN
Yes! I understand that the only parent who has ever come close to abusing me is you. You're a hypocrite and a whore and I hate you!

She throws the witch's hat and runs upstairs. Wind subsides. Jill, shaking, reached for a fallen item. Her daughter's door slams. Jill drops the item, and a flood of sobs follow.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Dylan sits on the floor, hands covering her face. Inhaling, exhaling, etc.

MITCH (O.S.)
Happy birthday.

Her eyes shoot up. He is really there, standing still as a scarecrow. A lit CUPCAKE in hand: MITCH.

EXT. HALL RESIDENCE - NIGHT

Standing proud in the front yard of Hall House: TEN "VOTE MORGAN HALL FOR MAYOR... AGAIN!" SIGNS. Sawyer SKATES to a stop and walks towards the door. A sudden SMILE.

INT. HALL RESIDENCE, FOYER - NIGHT

Sawyer bursts in, shaking off the outside chill.

SAWYER
I'm home!

MORGAN HALL (40s) peaks her head out from the hallway.

MORGAN
Thank GOODNESS! How was it? How'd it go? Performance kill? Of course it did. Listen, my honey baby boy, I need you to do a favor for me. Biggest favor of my life.

SAWYER
Mom.

MORGAN
Could you pretty please cherry on top give a listen to my reelection speech? This is very important.

SAWYER
Mom...

MORGAN
Just like that. OK, here we go! Ladies and Gentlemen of Black Willow, Massachusetts.

SAWYER
(MORE)

SAWYER (CONT'D)

Mom! I got the date!

Her whole head shifts focus, excited to the brim.

MORGAN

With that girl? Ah uh... Dylan?!

Sawyer nods. Morgan CHEERS loudly.

MORGAN

Tell me all about it. Every single detail. Where're you taking her?

SAWYER

The orchard.

MORGAN

Fantastic! In the morning right?
That's my boy! Just like I said.
Hey?

They disappear into the hallway.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Dylan and Mitch, still stuck in a stare. Candle wax dripping.

MITCH

I thought someone should sing you
happy birthday.

DYLAN

How do you know no one did?

MITCH

What?

DYLAN

Nothing. What did you hear?

MITCH

All of it... Are you angry?

Dylan sighs at this question, ignores it. She sits down.

DYLAN

How'd it go with Carrie?

Mitch tilts his head, messing with her jealousy. He sits right next to her. Very close.

MITCH

How'd it go with Sawyer?

Dylan gets up, keeps her distance.

DYLAN

Really well, actually.

MITCH

Oh yeah?

DYLAN

Yeah! You know what my favorite part about him is? It's that he doesn't lead people on out of selfish indecision.

MITCH

If I didn't know any better, I'd think you were insulting me.

DYLAN

Good thing you're so self aware.

MITCH

Who exactly am I leading on out of selfish indecision again? I don't think I caught that part.

DYLAN

You're so fucking annoying.

MITCH

Cause whoever this person is you're talking about, it sounds like they would have to have feelings for me in order to care if I was leading them on.

DYLAN

Get out. Literally leave.

MITCH

...Dylan Klaypool. Do you have feelings for me?

Dylan shakes her head in disbelief. She sits again, somewhere else now. Mitch joins, softened.

MITCH

I'm sorry about what happened with your mom.

DYLAN

(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(mentally elsewhere)
That's not what you should be
saying sorry for...

MITCH
What is it?

DYLAN
I'm trying to remember the number
my mom kept repeating.

MITCH
555-08-

DYLAN
54! Yes! Repeat it please.

MITCH
555-0854.

Dylan WRITES "555-0854" on PEN and PAPER.

DYLAN
I haven't been able to contact him
since getting grounded.

MITCH
Your dad?..What's he like?

DYLAN
He's a lot like you, actually.

MITCH
Selfish and indecisive?

DYLAN
...No. Uh. Well, he's... Incredibly
knowledgable without ever being
pretentious. Eccentric. Coded.
Believes in just about everything.

Dylan yawns.

MITCH
How is he now?

DYLAN
He'll die if I don't prove ghosts
exist.

MITCH
WHAT?!

DYLAN
(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)

There's a drug in the medication at his psych ward. It's really deadly. Made of paint fumes and all this other bad stuff. Turns skin scaly.

MITCH

Krokodil?

DYLAN

Yeah. But he might be all right if he behaves well.

MITCH

Why didn't you tell me?

DYLAN

...There's a lot of things we don't tell each other.

Dylan falls asleep.

INT. SALEM 1692, JAIL CELL - NIGHT

The snake slithers into a cell and over SARAH OSBORNE (40s).

DOROTHY (O.S.)

(whispering)

Sarah?..Sarah, have you any word of my mother? Sar...

She SCREAMS. She takes hold of the cell and yanks, calling out to a GUARD. The guard ignores her.

DOROTHY

SHE'S DEAD! SARAH OSBORNE HAS DIED...SHE IS DEAD! WILL YOU NOT HEAR ME? OH, YOU ARE VILE! YOU-

The snake closes over her mouth. Dorothy holds out her hand for it, burrows into a corner. It speaks in hissing tones.

SNAKE

Dorothy... Your mother likewise... she lies in prison, falsely accused of witchcraft... One week twice... Post the birth of sister Mercy... She is set... To hang...

DOROTHY

(MORE)

DOROTHY (CONT'D)

No. No! NO!

She sobs, only a 4-year-old girl. Sarah Osborne's body is pulled out of the cell.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, LIVING ROOM - DAY

The living room is a wreck. Halloween candy wrappers to sweep, blown away trinkets to place, dishes to clean, a destroyed necklace to throw away.

NEWS REPORTER (O.S.)

And just like that, this Halloween
is o-v-e-r OVER!

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BEDROOM - DAY

The remains of Dylan's almost Cinderella moment sit across her room, lit by new November light.

NEWS REPORTER (V.O.)

Let's take a look at how Black
Willow's biggest holiday of the
year faired for our economy.

Dylan is asleep in Mitch's arms. She wakes up. After the initial shock, she admires him in pain.

MITCH

(eyes closed, grinning)

Good morning.

She rolls the eyes. A sudden panic calls her to a clock.

DYLAN

It's 8:45?!

Dylan rushes to get dressed while Mitch is half asleep.

MITCH

Where are you going, early bird?

Dylan is brushing her teeth while throwing on her pants from behind the bed.

DYLAN

(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)
I have a date!

He's awake.

MITCH
What?

DYLAN
With Sawyer. He asked yesterday.

MITCH
And you're still going on
it?..Dylan.

DYLAN
What? What?! I don't know how you
actually feel! All you did was ask
if I have feelings for you. Like?!
Do you really think that takes any
ounce of courage in the world? If
you want me, tell me. Until then,
I'm going to the orchard with
Sawyer.

She leaves.

EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE - DRIVEWAY - DAY

Dylan walks outside. From around the corner, Mitch jumps in front of her.

MITCH
I want you. Actually.

...Oh, she's stopped.

A car pulls into the driveway. There's no way.

SAWYER
Dylan?

Dylan looks between them... and RUNS. Mitch gestures to Sawyer: just a moment!

EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE - DAY (CONTINUOUS)

Mitch chases Dylan into and throughout the graveyard.

MITCH

Dylan!

DYLAN

WHAT'S WRONG WITH YOU?!

MITCH

I was just doing what you said!

DYLAN

You were just doing everything it took to get the thing you can't have. I mean really? You suddenly want me? The moment I finally get a date.

MITCH

It's not suddenly!

DYLAN

Oh no it's been a long time coming, except for YESTERDAY when poor baby Carrie got the hate she deals on a daily basis.

MITCH

I've been flirting with you since the day we met!

DYLAN

Yeah but you never MEANT it!

MITCH

You never wanted me to mean it.

DYLAN

What kind of girl wouldn't want you to mean it?!

MITCH

I wasn't ready, but it's different now. Dylan!

DYLAN

No!

MITCH

Dylan!!!

Mitch catches up to Dylan, takes her by the wrists.

DYLAN

WHAT!

MITCH

(MORE)

MITCH (CONT'D)
I LOVE YOU.

Shock. Horror.

DYLAN
...Thank you.

MITCH
Well?

DYLAN
I... Don't care.

Yeah right. She composes herself, walking towards Sawyer like a tight robe walker, tripping a little.

INT. SAWYER'S CAR - DAY (CONTINUOUS)

Sawyer, having watch the whole scene, nearly grins. He alters his map, changing the destination from "HUGH ORCHARDS" to "GOODY LAND." Beside it, the words "PERMANENTLY CLOSED."

Dylan hops in his car, stiff as a board. She gives a little nod. Really? He scoffs, smiling. As the car pulls away, Dylan glances at the side mirror. Mitch stands in the driveway, watching them fade.

INT. DINER - DAY

Miguel sits at a table, coffee untouched, files scattered. His phone buzzes. UNKNOWN NUMBER. He hesitates, then answers.

MIGUEL
Detective Ramirez.

A hushed voice crackles through the line.

LOCAL (V.O.)
You're asking about Candice Good.

MIGUEL
Who is this?

LOCAL 1 (V.O.)
Someone who saw her. Near Mary's
(MORE)

LOCAL 1 (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Bath. Late at night.

MIGUEL
You're saying she's alive?

LOCAL 1 (V.O.)
...I don't know what she is. She
was there, but...

MIGUEL
What?

LOCAL
Her shadow stretched too far. Her
eyes weren't her's no more.

Miguel rolls his eyes.

MIGUEL
All right. I hardly think this is a
laughing matter. So if-

LOCAL
You gonna miss out on cracking this
case because a little jumbos
involved then you ain't gonna solve
a thing around these here parts,
city boy. You hearing me?

Miguel's jaw tightens.

MIGUEL
Go on.

LOCAL 1 (V.O.)
She stood by the water, murmurin'
something. Wind moved with her
words, like she was damn near
pullin' it.

MIGUEL
What did she say?

LOCAL 1 (V.O.)
Don't know. But when she looked my
way, it felt like I wasn't supposed
to see her.

The call cuts out. Miguel lowers the phone slowly, reeling.

EXT. ABANDONED PARK - DAY

Sawyer and Dylan pull into an abandoned parking lot.

DYLAN (O.S.)
This doesn't look like an orchard.

Sawyer gets out of the car, grabs his GUITAR and SKATEBOARD in the back seat. He opens the door for Dylan.

SAWYER
That's because it isn't.

He holds out his hand to help Dylan down, gestures for her to follow...

In the unkept park lies an abandoned carousel. It's gloriously creepy, something magic.

DYLAN
What is this place?

SAWYER
Is the energy all right?

DYLAN
It's OK...

Sawyer climbs through the trees, a local, reaching a high point.

SAWYER
It's an old park my mom's trying to clear out. But it's good for skating.

Sawyer JUMPS. He comes up on the opposite end, skateboarding. Dylan smiles. She watches until he returns, taking a seat beside her.

DYLAN
Why was it abandoned?

SAWYER
It never opened. They tried to launch in 2016.

Sawyer pulls out a joint and rolling paper, gets to business.

DYLAN
2016? What happened in 2016?

SAWYER
(MORE)

SAWYER (CONT'D)

The summer of beasts... Oh, it was crazy. Something like overtook all the animals. All of them. Like ten people died and a few went missing. We had to stay inside all break.

Dylan processes this, touches her arm sleeve.

SAWYER

(CONT'D)

You all right?

Dylan nods, her mind elsewhere. Sawyer isn't a fool.

SAWYER

...You know, Dakota and I are kind of a thing.

DYLAN

Then why are you on a date with me?!

He gives Dylan a look.

SAWYER

Mitch?

She simmers, pouty, and takes a hit. COUGHS wildly. He hits her on the back to help. It ends.

DYLAN

...I actually know how to skate.

Silence. They LAUGH.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, ATTIC - DAY

Dylan paces, her voice sharp with restrained urgency.

DYLAN

(On the house phone)

Linda, it's Dylan Klaypool... I know, I've been grounded. Can I talk to my dad?

She pauses, her pace slowing.

DYLAN

(CONT'D)

(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)
What do you mean he can't take
calls? Is he... worse?

LINDA (V.O.)
He's stable, but the doctors think
isolation is best for now. It's
protocol, Dylan.

Dylan fumes.

LINDA (V.O.)
I'll keep an eye on him. If you
need anything, just say the word.

DYLAN
How about getting the nurses to
stop giving him krokodil?

An insufferable beat.

LINDA (V.O.)
All our medications have been pre-
approved by the government.

DYLAN
Tell him I tried to call. Please.

Dylan hangs up.

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, MS. MARRERO'S CLASSROOM - DAY

Mitch grinds a pencil into his desk. Dylan enters, head
down, and he perks up. MS. MARRERO writes "THE CRUCIBLE ACT
THREE" on the board. Dylan sits next to Mitch. He analyzes
her.

DYLAN
Stop.

MS. MARRERO
We are now entering Act 3 of The
Crucible.

Dylan leans into Mitch.

DYLAN
(whispering)
(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)
What can you tell me about the
summer of beasts?

Spoken simultaneously with:

MS. MARRERO (O.S.)
As it traditionally goes in act 3,
we'll begin to see tensions rise as
mass hysteria grips the town.

Mitch looks more taken aback than she expected. Triggered.

MITCH
...In 2016?

DYLAN
Yes.

Ms. Marrero continues.

MS. MARRERO (O.S.)
Now. Connecting this to the Red
Scare, we are going to watch this
video from the McCarthy Trials.
Then discuss the parallels.

The room dims as the video starts.

MITCH
2016 wasn't a Summer. It was a
siege. The animals turned. People
died. Some say it was a disease,
but... It wasn't natural.

Mitch shuts off.

DYLAN
Mitch?

MITCH
Why do you ask?

MS. MARRERO (O.S.)
Dylan? Mitch? Care to share?

Ms. Marrero is hovering above them, hand on a hip. The whole
class is now watching.

DYLAN
Just connecting the dots.

The school INTERCOM crackles on.

INTERCOM
(MORE)

INTERCOM (CONT'D)
Carrie Landry and Veda Warcloud to
Dean Richard's office please.

Everyone looks at Carrie and Veda, who scowl at each other.

OMITTED

INT. SCHOOL HALLWAY - DAY (CONTINUOUS)

In the school hallway sits a framed photo of a smiling man, his arms crossed. Below it is his title, DEAN, and below that is his name: JOHN RICHARD (40S). Carrie and Veda exit his office, mid-argument.

CARRIE
Five thousand death threats
scattered across the gym floor. And
gee! I wonder who couldn't done it.

VEDA
It's called delivering justice.

CARRIE
Justice?! I got detention all week
for being a victim!

VEDA
You are literally white, straight,
skinny, and rich. Please shut the
fuck up.

CARRIE
Actually I'm a quarter Indonesian
so.

VEDA
You are not a victim.

CARRIE
You are so ANNOYING! And obsessive!
What do you not understand? Mitch.
Hates. You. You don't need to come
to his defense like a fucked up
little chihuahua. OK?

VEDA
(MORE)

VEDA (CONT'D)

Family's kind of a safe thing. I
wouldn't expect you to understand.

Carrie gets in her face. Students begin to watch.

CARRIE

What do you mean by that?

VEDA

Well. I couldn't get my brother to
kill himself.

A collective GASP. Carrie moves to lunge.

DAKOTA (O.S.)

Carrie, let it go.

Carrie holds herself back, but doesn't move. Dakota steps
between them. She looks unkept and sleepless.

DAKOTA

She's literally not worth it.

VEDA

(to Carrie)

I'll be seeing you.

CARRIE

(mocking)

I'll be seeing you. Thanks to Dean
Richard's incompetence, not soon
enough.

At the mention of the name, Dakota visibly flinches. Sawyer
rounds the corner, and approaches her.

SAWYER

Hey. Where have you been?

Dakota barely glances at him.

DAKOTA

Sorry.

She rushes off, unsteady, as Sawyer watches her go.

MITCH (V.O.)

Your turn.

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, TBD - DAY

Hidden by shelves, Dylan and Mitch face each other, speaking in a charged whisper.

MITCH

Why the sudden interest in 2016?

DYLAN

My attacks took place in 2016. It just feels too coincidental.

MITCH

But by a ghost, no? Not an animal.

DYLAN

They were animalistic attacks by a paranormal entity.

MITCH

OK. What does that look like?

Dylan gives him a hard stare, takes off her sweater. Mitch gives her an oh? look. She responds with a no look.

Dylan unwraps, revealing her scars. She reads his reaction, rewrapping with haste. He stops her, stares at the wound.

DYLAN

It's somewhat chronic. This part still bleeds sometimes.

MITCH

After ten years?

She pulls away, wrapping it up.

DYLAN

Symbolic, I know. You've already seen the one on my head.

Mitch touches Dylan's face, brushing away her bangs to reveal the scar. Dylan softens. Painfully.

Dylan

Stop...

Dylan looks down, never once meeting his eyes.

DYLAN

You've been a terrible distraction. Unintentionally of course, but-

MITCH

And Sawyer isn't?!

DYLAN

(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)

BUT. It seems my dad's gotten much worse. And I just, I need to focus.

MITCH

(solemn)

Sure. Of course.

He grins, lightening the mood just enough.

MITCH

But don't pretend you're not curious.

DYLAN

Please shut up.

MITCH

There's a theory I have. That the animals in 2016 were possessed.

DYLAN

Possessed?

MITCH

A medium in town told me. I can take you to her after school.

DYLAN

I can go alone.

MITCH

And how exactly do you plan on getting there, Miss too afraid to drive and doesn't own a bike?

He nods to to a broom stick in the corner.

MITCH

You gonna hop on a broomstick and fly?

Dylan smirks.

EXT. THE WILLOW READER COTTAGE, DRIVEWAY - DAY

A crooked little house looms at the end of a gravel path. The sign reads: "THE WILLOW READER MADAME ZUGASTI." Amongst it's NEIGHBOR(S), Halloween decor is coming down as Christmas lights are going up.

Dylan walks beside Sawyer, skateboard in hand.

DYLAN
Thank you for letting me borrow
this... You all right?

SAWYER
Oh yeah, yeah of course. Sorry. I'm
just distracted.

DYLAN
What's wrong?

SAWYER
Ah. It's an awkward topic.

DYLAN
Dakota acting off today?

SAWYER
Yes! You saw it too? Do you think
it's us?

DYLAN
I didn't feel any extra attention.

SAWYER
Maybe I'm just imagining it.
Anyway, I should head out if I'm
walking home. Be safe.

Sawyer leaves. Dylan walks up the steps.

EXT. THE WILLOW READER COTTAGE - DAY (CONTINUOUS)

Dylan skates to a stop in front of a storefront cottage. It
says: "THE WILLOW READER MADAME ZUGASTI."

She walks up the steps, looks at her feet. There's a FLOOR
MAT that reads "Knock $(1/z)^{(\min((x - 2\sqrt{xy}) + y)/2)}$
times."

Dylan knocks ONCE. She comes ever so close to the door. A
peephole bolts open, revealing MADAME ZUGASTI's two purple
shadowed, crazy eyes. Dylan JUMPS back.

DYLAN
I'm here for a reading.

The peephole shuts... Madame Zugasti unlocks SEVERAL locks.
She opens the door: A small, plump woman, even shorter than
Dylan, dressed lavishly in anything other than Western wear.

DYLAN
(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)

Hello.

Before Dylan knows it, she's being SNIFFED. Very close up.

DYLAN

Oh. OK. Um.

Madame Zugasti steps back, stares Dylan down. She spins abruptly, walking inside.

DYLAN

Should I...? I'm just gonna follow you in then.

INT. THE WILLOW READER COTTAGE, FORTUNE TELLER AREA - DAY

It's an eccentric space filled with trolls. Troll dolls. Everywhere. Madame Zugasti swipes Fritos chips from her reading space.

MADAME ZUGASTI

Sit.

Dylan hesitates, then sits.

MADAME ZUGASTI

Hand.

Dylan rushes, holds out her hand. Madame Zugasti holds it, inhaling. Her eyes closed. She CONVULSES.

DYLAN

Madame?!

MADAME ZUGASTI

EVIL! EVIL! EVIL!

Dylan freaks out. Abrupt, Madame Zugasti shakes out her head. Back to normal.

MADAME ZUGASTI

Who are you?

DYLAN

D... Dylan Klaypool.

MADAME ZUGASTI

You hold great, great power. Power with potential for terrible things.
(MORE)

MADAME ZUGASTI (CONT'D)
I sense... a chain of sorts. Yes.
Breakable by none other than you.
Oh, it's heavy. Quite heavy indeed.

DYLAN
I was... only wondering about these
attacks from my childhood. Would
you know, well, are they from the
same animal or entity as the summer
of beast attacks?

MADAME ZUGASTI
(building it up)
...No.

Dylan deflates.

EXT/INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, KITCHEN TABLE - DUSK

Jill walks in from the kitchen and sees Dylan on the dining
table doing school work. Eyes lock. Dylan storms out, taking
her snack: APPLES.

JILL
(calling out)
Don't forget you have your job with
Miguel today at 6pm.

DYLAN
I didn't forget!

The door SHUTS loudly. Jill SIGHS. She turns around...

INT. YOUNG DYLAN RESIDENCE, KITCHEN - DAY

...ten years younger. Jill is cleaning. YOUNG DYLAN (6)
sits, eating APPLE SLICES. Her arms are wrapped in BANDAGES.

JILL
Dylan, mommy is going to have a
nice talk with daddy and a
detective, ok? So we can find out
who hurts you at night. Does that
sound good? OK. And while we're
doing that, guess who's coming to
(MORE)

JILL (CONT'D)
take spend time with you? Grandma!

CANDICE (O.S.)
Did someone say...

CANDICE GOOD (60s) appears like magic from around the hallway, startling Jill.

CANDICE
GRANDMA! How's my little peanut?

Candice struts towards Dylan. Dylan smiles. The first time.

JILL
She's still not talking, Mom.

CANDICE
(to Dylan privately)
Oh, that's only because there's
such a great deal going on in
there.

She points to Dylan's noggin. Nathan walks in.

NATHAN
(warm)
Hi.

JILL
(cold)
Hi.

She continues cleaning. Candice PUTS a little HAT and COAT on Dylan. Dylan exchanges a comforting look with her dad.

There's a knock at the door.

JILL
That must be the detective.

CANDICE
We will get it!

INT. YOUNG DYLAN RESIDENCE FRONT DOOR - DAY

Candice, followed by Dylan, sweeps to the door, opens it grandly. The first thing Dylan sees are the man's shoes: shiny. She follows the outfit up, revealing...

MIGUEL
(MORE)

MIGUEL (CONT'D)
Cat got your tongue, Kiddo?

INT. POLICE DEPARTMENT, HODGE'S OFFICE - DAY

Dylan sits at a desk in the police department, case files splayed before her. Miguel watches with concerned patience.

DYLAN
What was that?

MIGUEL
Oh it was a joke. I just asked if a cat got your tongue, but you got this? You know what to do? Collect all the files, alphabetize them, put them in the proper drawer?

DYLAN
Sure.

He nods, leaves. Dylan grabs a file, finds the letter, places it in the proper drawer. She grabs the next and does a double take: there's a MUGSHOT of Parker in it.

DYLAN
Underage possession of alcohol.

She chuckles, placing it in the drawer. She checks a few more until, suddenly, her smirk fades. This file is labeled: CASE AGAINST MICHAEL HUGH FOR THE MURDER OF RAYMOND COLE.

Her eyes widen, breath shallow. She flips through the file.

DYLAN
(under her breath)
Michael Hugh...

The door creaks open behind her. Dylan close the file and slides it back into the pile.

RONALD HODGE strides in.

HODGE
Be I mistaken or is that Miguel's little girl?

DYLAN
Hello, Chief Hodge.

HODGE
(MORE)

HODGE (CONT'D)

Staying busy? What cha got there?

DYLAN

Oh. Um... Actually, you might want to see it. It's about an old murder that took place in your new house.

HODGE

Ah... don't I know it.

He sits down. Dylan follows.

DYLAN

Really? Wha- what happened?

HODGE

Tragic story, really. Very wealthy family. The Hughs. Only a teenage daughter. Sandra. One night, a man. Big fellow, I heard. He breaks into the house and tries to have his way with her. Sheer luck the dad was walking by. Shot him twice and saved the little girl's life.

DYLAN

And the man?

HODGE

Oh, he died on the spot I believe.

DYLAN

This case is trying to defend him.

HODGE

Yep. Sick, really. We been getting that same claim for years. Always from the same source. Most likely a relative. We let it lie, you see. Out of respect.

He gets up.

HODGE

Crazy town, Black Willow. You'll learn all about in between these walls.

He leaves.

She rushes to the printer, makes a copy of the file. One word is emphasized. The location: "BOSTON, MA."

EXT. WILLOW ROAD - NIGHT

Dylan trudges uphill through Willow Road, carrying the skateboard. Her knees are scraped. Backpack heavy.

DYLAN
(talking to herself)
Hey, Sawyer. Yeah no I know we barely know each other, but I was just wondering if you're interested in taking an overnight, four hour road trip with me to Boston.

She kicks a pebble. A streetlight up ahead flickers and she reaches for her necklace. Nothing there. Be brave. Something is behind her. She hears it, SPINS to see.

It's a DEER, big brown-eyed. Dylan breathes out her awe. You can see it in the air. She mouths: Hi. Dylan pulls out her apples. Comes closer, pets her.

The deer SPOOKS, running for her life. Dylan looks hurt. She turns. Under the streetlight stands a MASKED MAN. He's holding a HUNTING RIFLE, and he raises it to her.

INT. BLACK WILLOW WOODS - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

GUNSHOTS. Dylan is running for her life through the woods.

DYLAN
HELP! HELP! SOMEBODY HELP!

She dives behind a tree, her chest heaving. She grabs a rock and hurls it into the dark for distraction.

Another gunshot shatters the night. Dylan presses herself against the bark. She turns to grab another rock—

And freezes. The SNAKE is slithering in the underbrush. Its unblinking eyes meet hers. Then, in a slow, fluid motion, the snake begins to morph. Its sleek form stretches, twists—until it transforms into a BROOM.

Dylan stares, her mind screaming impossible.

She's hesitant to touch it, naturally. Until there's another gun shot. She grabs the damn thing and THUNDER CRACKS.

Dylan is airborne, clutching the broom with a death grip.

DYLAN
(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(eyes shut)
No. No. No-

She opens an eye and almost loses balance. But when another gunshot comes from below, instinct takes over. She pulls it together.

HEAVY WIND runs through the Autumn foliage. She soars through the trees. The MASKED MAN'S SCREAMS fade into night as Dylan flies higher, steadier, wind ripping through her hair.

INT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, DINING ROOM - NIGHT

A sullen Mitch eats dinner as ABIEZER MARRERO watches him.

Behind Mitch, through the wall to wall windows looking out onto the graveyard, Abiezer sees Dylan flopping onto the ground post broomstick flight. He seems quite unsurprised.

ABIEZER
How's is Dylan?

Mitch stabs his food with a fork. Abiezer nods. Ah, I see.

Behind Mitch, Dylan pops up from the floor with crazed hair and a dirty face. She sees Abiezer, but he turns away as though he saw nothing.

ABIEZER
But you have feelings for her.

As Mitch processes this question, Dylan's broomstick is busy turning back into a snake. She flings it into the bushes, then bites her nails as if in regret, waving goodbye to it.

MITCH
...She's no good.

Mitch notices Abiezer is distracted and turns to see what he's looking at, but Dylan ducks just in time. Abiezer grins.

ABIEZER
She's good.

Their doorbell RINGS.

EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, FRONT DOOR - NIGHT

Mitch opens the door to find Dylan, breathless and crazed, holding up the file: CASE AGAINST MICHAEL HUGH FOR THE MURDER OF RAYMOND COLE.

DYLAN
I cannot go alone.

Mitch looks at the files, then back at Dylan.

MITCH
Boston? I'll book a place.

She could smile.

DYLAN (V.O.)
I no longer believe in decorating
for Christmas right at the end of
October.

EXT. MARY'S BATH - NIGHT

Miguel arrives at Mary's Bath, holding the compass at the pond's edge. The needle jitters. He taps the glass once. It spins erratically, then points to the water, where a faint glow seems to swim.

DYLAN (V.O.)
I've decided it's an awful
disservice to the silence
between...

He squints, then shakes his head.

INT. GARDNER RESIDENCE, LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

HARLOW GARDNER wears an oversized rock t-shirt while SEWING a dress and watching reality TV.

DYLAN (V.O.)
...and a premature plunge into the
season of sleep.

A knock. She opens the door. Sawyer is standing in the rain.

INT. GARDNER RESIDENCE, DAKOTA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Dim light. Dakota's in sweats, clutching a blanket. She faces away from the door. Harlow opens it, followed by Sawyer.

HARLOW
I don't know. Maybe she'll talk to you.

SAWYER
Dakota?

Dakota sparks up, looking at Sawyer. She will.

INT. HODGE RESIDENCE, LEXIE'S BATHROOM - NIGHT

Lexie clutches the toilet, pale and trembling.

DYLAN (V.O.)
But more than anything, it goes against nature.

She sobs.

DYLAN (V.O.)
Nature in all its forms.

INT. MS. MARRERO'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Ms. Marrero takes down her Halloween DECOR, humming.

DYLAN (V.O.)
It's 4 hours and 15 minutes to Boston...

She puts it in a box, crossing a FRAMED PHOTO of MITCH and his MOTHER. His mother has a massive SCAR across her face.

INT. ONYX CAT COFFEE SHOP - NIGHT

A rainy window. Veda flips the shop sign to CLOSED.

DYLAN (V.O.)
...and based on what I know about Black Willow...

She grabs two coffee cups, walks towards a table to CARRIE.

DYLAN (V.O.)
(MORE)

DYLAN (V.O.) (CONT'D)
...I'm willing to bet the in
between could alter everything.

Veda sits with Carrie.

INT. PSYCH WARD FOR THE CRIMINALLY INSANE, LOBBY - NIGHT

A visitor ID attempts to print.

DYLAN (V.O.)
Just listen to me.

It's Jill's photo, her name. For Chicago State Psych Ward.

INT. PSYCH WARD FOR THE CRIMINALLY INSANE, CELL - NIGHT

Jill is guided to a padded cell.

There's Nathan, scale skinned.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, SILO ATTIC - NIGHT

Dylan finishes writing in her journal. She looks up.

DYLAN (V.O.)
Have I ever sounded so brave?

Never.

EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE - DAY

Camera's FLASH, drowning Dylan.

REPORTER 1
Dylan, can you describe the
killer's mask.

Spoken simultaneously with:

REPORTER 2
Do you believe this killer is
connected to the disappearance of
(MORE)

REPORTER 2 (CONT'D)
your grandmother, Candice Good?

REPORTER 3
Are you afraid that he'll return?

The question is a tidal wave. Miguel rescues her.

NEWS ANCHOR (V.O.)
A masked murderer is on the loose
in Black Willow...

EXT. BLACK WILLOW WOODS - NIGHT

Flashlights lead the way. Miguel, joined by a group of OFFICERS, inspects a tree: bullet holes. Bullets on the ground.

NEWS ANCHOR (V.O.)
...Last spotted in the south woods,
officials say he escaped the scene
just moments after...

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY - DAY

Dylan walks fast, headphones in, her gaze fixed forward.

NEWS ANCHOR (V.O.)
...Local teenager Dylan Klaypool
escaped with her life.

Students whisper and stare as she passes, including Carrie.

EXT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY - BUS STOP - DAY

The NEWS ANCHOR in the flesh.

NEWS ANCHOR
This is coming just one month after
the ongoing disappearance of
Candice Good...

An IMAGE of Candice appears on screen.

NEWS ANCHOR
(CONT'D)
...Dylan Klaypool's grandmother.
(MORE)

NEWS ANCHOR (CONT'D)
For many people in Black Willow,
both cases point to one question.

INT. HALL RESIDENCE, KITCHEN - DAY

Sawyer pours two cups of coffee. The TV blares.

POLITICIAN 1 (V.O.)
Does Mayor Hall have what it takes
to protect our town...

He walks into...

EXT. HALL RESIDENCE, MORGAN'S ROOM - DAY

The same news channel on a TV in Morgan's room.

POLITICIAN 2
Absolutely not.

POLITICIAN 1
No, I didn't think so.

Sawyer enters, hands his mom a coffee. They half hug.

POLITICIAN 1
Thankfully for us, a second
candidate is promising change and a
fresh start.

Their eyes meet, heavy with unspoken concern.

EXT. LIGHTHOUSE BEACH - NIGHT

Pale moonlight casts rippled waves over Lighthouse Beach. A
YOUNG COUPLE drinks. The boy strips.

GIRL
You're crazy!

Half undressed, he lifts her. They spin, laugh. She watches
him run into the ocean. Blushes: why not! She undresses and
runs towards him until something moonlit stops her.

GIRL
(MORE)

GIRL (CONT'D)
Babe, do you see that?

BOY
See what?

She goes towards it, rewrapping herself.

BOY
(CONT'D)
Where do you think your going?

He runs to her as she goes closer to it.

GIRL
I think it's a dolphin or
something.

It's not a dolphin. It's CANDICE GOOD. The girl SCREAMS.
END OF EPISODE

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"The Girl Who Cried Ghoul"

Written by

Taylor Castro

Based on

"The Haunting of Dylan Klaypool: Whispers in Black Willow"

by James A. Ross